Skill – Deception (Charisma) · SRD 5.2.1

Deception is used to **lie, disguise the truth or mislead**: false name, bluff, acting innocent. It uses a **Charisma (Deception)** check via the **Influence** action.

Against someone smelling a lie, it's a **contested check** with their Insight.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Charisma (Deception)** check.
2. **Influence** action.
3. Contested by the target's **Insight**.
4. The bigger the lie, the higher the DC.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 places Deception under the Influence action and confirms the contest.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say what success brings if the target already suspects. Fix: attitude and context modify the DC.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can play out trust taking hold or cracking.

Step 1 – Announce:

The player states the lie.

Step 2 – Assess:

Plausible? Does the target have reason to doubt?

Step 3 – Set the DC:

Contested by the target's Insight, or DC 15 as appropriate.

Step 4 – Roll:

1d20 + Charisma + proficiency.

Step 5 – Resolve:

Success: the target believes; failure: they suspect or unmask.

Example: Mira poses as a merchant. Deception 17 against the guard's Insight 12: he believes her.

⚠ Common questions:

Deception or Persuasion?

Deception: lying; Persuasion: honesty.

Against a born liar?

Same contest.

A big lie?

Higher DC.

Can I lie to a truth-compelled creature?

Not if a spell forces truth.

Does a disguise help?

Yes: Advantage possible with a kit.

Retry?

Disadvantage after a failure.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Implausible lie

Can it succeed? **Option**: automatic failure.

Forged papers

Forgery. **Option**: see the forgery kit.

Several people

Lying to a group. **Option**: one roll per target.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Influence

Deception uses the Influence action.

Contest

It's opposed by Insight.

Disguise

A disguise can grant Advantage.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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